

40. Which of the following states ranks first in India in length of roads?

- (a) Maharashtra (b) Uttar Pradesh
(c) Madhya Pradesh (d) Rajasthan

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2018

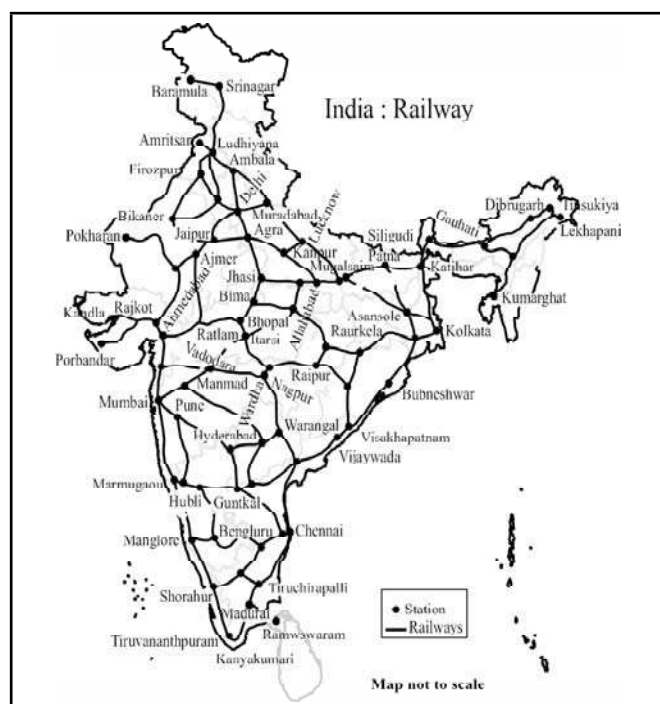
Ans. (a)

Among the given states, Maharashtra ranks first in India in terms of the length of roads.

ii. Rail Transport

*The first railway on the Indian subcontinent ran over a stretch of 34km from Bombay (Mumbai) to Thane on 16th April, 1853.

*The rail network was started between Kolkata and Raniganj (39km) in 1854 AD, and between, Chennai (Madras) and Arkonam (101 km) in 1856. In India, until 1871, the presidency towns of Kolkata, Mumbai and Chennai were connected by the railways. On the basis of width, the Indian Railways routes are divided into three parts.



- (i) **Meter Gauge**- The distance between the two tracks is 1 meter or 1000 mm.
(ii) **Broad Gauge** - The distance between the tracks is 1.676 m or 1676 mm or 5 ½ feet.
(iii) **Narrow Gauge**- The distance between the two tracks is 762 mm or 610 mm.

*The longest railway route in India is in the state of Uttar Pradesh. *According to the Indian Railway Yearbook, 2023-

24 the total length of the rail route in the country is **69181** km. during 2023-24. The length of Meter Gauge is **1159** km, the length of Broad Gauge is **66820** km and the length of Narrow Gauge is **1202** km. *Due to flat topography, low slope, high agricultural productivity and high population density in the Gangetic plain, the highest concentration of rail circuits is seen. The entire rail circuit is divided into 17 railway zones. *The headquarters of the North Central Railway zone is located in Prayagraj. The North Central Railway zone was established on April 1, 2003.

*Indian Railways is one of the world's largest rail networks with 69181 route kilometers of route lengths as of 31.03.2024. Out of 69181 RKMs., BG constitutes 66820 RKMs. (96.59%), MG 1159 RKMs. (1.67%) and NG 1202 RKMs. (1.74%). The growth of its route length, running and track kilometers. since independence is as follows-

Year	Route Kms.	Running Track Kms.	Total Track Kms.
1950-51	53596	59315	77609
1960-61	56247	63602	83706
1970-71	59790	71669	98546
1980-81	61240	75860	104480
1990-91	62367	78607	108858
2000-01	63028	81865	108706
2010-11	64173	87114	114037
2020-21	68103	100866	126611
2021-22	68043	102831	128305
2022-23	68584	106493	132310
2023-24	69181	109748	135207

Zone/ Headquarters	Route Kms.	Running Track Kms.	Total Track Kms.
Central, Mumbai	4275	7435	9716
Eastern, Kolkata	2841	6067	7698
East Central, Hajipur	4377	7048	9332
East Coast, Bhubaneswar	3071	5609	6987
Northern, New Delhi	7406	10702	13957
North Central, Prayagraj	3522	5774	7089
North Eastern, Gorakhpur	3492	5373	5581
Northeast Frontier, Maligaon (Guwahati)	4348	5269	7053
North Western, Jaipur	5712	8131	8561